

more retweets by posting a quote, or start a larger conversation by posting a question.

- ◆ **Memes** are a mainstay in the day-to-day working of several Internet giants, including 4Chan, Reddit, and Facebook. It would seem that Twitter users don't especially like memes, which is evidenced by the fact that the smallest percentages of tweets are memes. It makes no sense to indulge in something that, even if it did well, wouldn't produce any traffic worth speaking about.
- ◆ A surprisingly effective way of spreading your influence is to actually go out and ask for retweets. Tweets that ask for retweets are retweeted a stunning 400% more than tweets that don't ask for it. While it might seem like an attention-gathering tactic, and content is still king, the fact remains that it works.

Now that the makings of a good twitter account are fairly evident, here are some bad habits that will decrease your retweets by a substantial amount. This includes talking about yourself (if it's a personal Twitter account), not asking for retweets, not including links, just parroting other people's opinions, and most importantly, dumbing it down. Twitter is a website for a fairly literate audience, and to make your content sound like it's only suitable for ages 8 and below isn't going to help you win any extra viewership.

Another counter-intuitive way of making sure that you can market your tweets to the best of your abilities is automating them. If you glance through the most popular twitter accounts in use today, you'll notice that most of them are extremely popular outside Twitter. What that means is that they're popular on Twitter not because of their content, but because they're popular outside of this social networking site as well. It should also be noted that the few accounts that didn't belong to this category follow a strategy that is essentially a combination of high quality content and automation. Accounts like @Whattheffects, @BreakingNews and others of a similar type have a follower count north of a heady 5 million, and use this mantra quite effectively. The lesson to be learned here is that automation isn't all bad. This doesn't mean that you spam your followers with blog post after blog post, or keep making jokes every 10 minutes. After careful experimentation, you might be able to find a good compromise between automation and the personal touch.

A good way to do this is to schedule tweets. Commonly available tools such as Hootsuite or SproutSocial can be used to do this effectively. They also include an advanced search feature that you can use to look up what